

# Activity 3 – 5-Step Critique Framework

Deciding: Refine, Re-Prompt, or Start Over

## Purpose

Practice a simple, repeatable **5-step check** to evaluate any AI output and decide whether to **keep and refine it, change direction with a new prompt, or start again**.

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## The 5 Steps (Quick Reference)

- **Purpose** – What is this output for, and for whom?
- **Plausibility** – Does it pass a basic sense check?
- **Evidence** – How do we know it's true / appropriate?
- **Stakes** – What happens if it's wrong or weak?
- **Action** – What should we change, keep, or do next?

You don't need to memorise the labels – just move through these questions in order.

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## Core Activity (Teaching / Pedagogy)

### Step 1 – Choose an AI output

Pick one AI-generated output from earlier activities, for example:

- A summary or LMS announcement
- A short quiz or set of questions

- A rewritten assignment brief
- A teaching idea or activity design

Paste or describe it here:

**AI output:**

## **Step 2 – Apply the 5-step critique**

In pairs or individually, work through the five steps.

Use the questions below to guide you. Jot down **one strength** and **one concern / risk** for each step.

### **Purpose**

- What job is this text trying to do?
- Who is it written for, and is the tone right?

**Strength:**

**Concern / risk:**

### **Plausibility**

- Does anything sound obviously wrong, vague, or oversimplified?
- Does it fit with what you already know?

**Strength:**

**Concern / risk:**

### **Evidence**

- Are important claims supported by examples, data, or references?
- What would you need to check before trusting this?

**Strength:**

**Concern / risk:**

## Stakes

- Is this for low-stakes use (ideas, drafts) or high-stakes use (assessment, policy, advice)?
- If this is wrong, who might be misled or harmed?

**Strength / note:**

**Concern / risk:**

## Action

- What should you keep, change, or delete?
- Do you refine this, re-prompt, or start from scratch?

**What I will do next:**

## Step 3 – Make a decision

Based on your notes above, decide:

- ☐ **Keep and lightly edit** (good enough with small fixes)
- ☐ **Re-prompt in a new direction** (needs clearer instructions)
- ☐ **Discard and start over** (fundamentally off-target)

Write one sentence explaining your choice:

Remember: the goal is not to prove the AI is “bad”, but to make an informed decision about how (or whether) to use this output in your teaching.

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## Optional: Let AI Critique Itself

If you have time and access, you can ask the AI to apply a similar critique to its own output, then compare with your judgement.

Example prompt:

Using the following 5-step critique framework:

1) Purpose, 2) Plausibility, 3) Evidence, 4) Stakes, 5) Action, critically evaluate the output you just produced.

For each step, briefly comment on:

- Strengths of the output
- Limitations or risks
- One concrete suggestion to improve it for use with university students in [discipline].

Ask:

- What did the AI notice that you also saw?
  - What did **you** see that it missed?
  - Would you trust it to do this critique for you?
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## Variants for Researchers and Professional Staff

You can use the same 5-step critique for other AI outputs.

### If you are mainly doing research

Try critiquing an AI-generated:

- **Abstract** for a paper or conference
- “**Related work**” paragraph or section
- **Summary** of several articles

Ask, for each step:

- Purpose: Is this fit for the **venue / audience** (journal, conference, grant)?
- Plausibility: Does it reflect how the field actually talks about this topic?
- Evidence: Are citations plausible? Are key authors or theories missing?
- Stakes: What happens if I rely on this in a submission?
- Action: Do I keep parts, rework heavily, or discard?

## If you are in a professional / administrative role

Try critiquing an AI-generated:

- **Student information email**
- **Web page copy** about a process (e.g., special consideration, enrolment)
- **FAQ** for staff or students

Consider:

- Purpose: Does it explain the process clearly and appropriately?
  - Plausibility: Does it actually match how our systems and policies work?
  - Evidence: Does it give concrete details (deadlines, links, contacts) that need checking?
  - Stakes: What happens if a student acts on incorrect or incomplete information?
  - Action: How would you edit or rewrite this before sending/publishing?
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## Reflection / Notes

Use the prompts below and the space provided.

- Did the 5 steps help you see strengths and risks more clearly?
- At which step did you find the **most useful insight** (purpose, plausibility, evidence, stakes, or action)?
- How might you adapt this framework for your students, research, or professional context?

(Notes:)

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